Title: Account Lockout and Sign-in Recovery
Category: account_access

[SAMPLE DOCUMENT - synthetic content for the HelpDeskAI project, not an official company policy]

Symptoms and scope
A user cannot sign in after repeated incorrect passwords or sees a message that the account is temporarily locked.

Troubleshooting procedure

1. Confirm the username format and check Caps Lock and keyboard layout. If the password was recently changed, update saved credentials only in approved applications. A stale password in a background service can repeatedly trigger a lockout.

2. After the lockout message appears, stop retrying and wait 15 minutes from the last failed attempt. Repeated attempts during the lockout period do not shorten it and may make diagnosis harder.

3. Open Meridian Identity Gate and choose the supported account recovery flow. Complete the identity checks using the user's own registered recovery method. A recovery link expires after 10 minutes; if it expires, request a new one rather than forwarding the old link.

4. After access is restored, update the saved password in approved devices and sign in once. If the same lockout returns, record which device or application may still be using old credentials and contact the Service Desk.

Ownership and handoff
Identity Operations owns identity verification, account recovery controls, and lockout configuration. The Service Desk collects symptoms and helps identify stale saved credentials. Managers do not receive passwords or recovery codes.

Escalation and priority
Use medium priority when a single user remains locked out after the 15-minute wait and supported recovery. Use high priority if multiple accounts are locked unexpectedly or a suspected credential attack is underway. Report any unexpected verification prompt or suspected compromise immediately through the security route.

Diagnostic details and records
AUTH-403 means the identity service has placed an account into a temporary lockout after repeated failed authentication. It does not mean that a user lacks permission to a specific application; permission denial is a separate condition described by the relevant application owner.

Questions and answers

Q: Should I keep trying different passwords?
A: No. Stop retries and use the supported recovery flow.

Q: Can the Service Desk tell me my current password?
A: No. Passwords are not displayed or sent to support staff.

Ticket quality checklist
Before submitting, confirm that the report states the observed symptom rather than only a guessed cause. Separate facts from assumptions, include the time and location, and describe the troubleshooting already completed. If a step could expose a person to electrical, battery, water, or moving-equipment hazards, stop and use the safety escalation route instead of continuing. Do not bypass access controls, disable security protections, open sealed equipment, or use another person's account. A support team may ask for additional evidence, but provide it only through the

approved company channel and only when it is needed to diagnose the issue.

Expected outcome
A successful first-line check should either restore the affected function or narrow the fault to a specific service, device, destination, or building component. If the result is unchanged, preserve the original error text and report which numbered steps were completed. Do not repeat a failed action indefinitely; use the stated escalation condition and let the owning team continue diagnosis.